

Advent Calendar — Quickstart

Add the metaobject-driven advent calendar section to an **existing** Shopify theme. Happy path, by hand in the Admin. Full reference: `INTEGRATION.md` .

Before you start

- A staff account with access to **Settings** → **Custom data** (metaobjects) and **Online Store** → **Themes**.
- The theme you will edit — duplicate it first (*Themes* → ... → *Duplicate*) so you work on a copy, then publish when happy.
- The `shopify-advent-calendar/` folder from this project. Only four subfolders go into the theme: `sections/` , `snippets/` , `assets/` , `locales/` .

1 • Add the section files to the theme

Online Store → **Themes** → ... → **Edit code** on your working copy. Add each file below with *Add a new section / snippet / asset* and paste its contents from `shopify-advent-calendar/<folder>/<file>` .

In the theme	Files to add
<code>sections/</code>	<code>advent-calendar.liquid</code>
<code>snippets/</code>	<code>advent-door.liquid</code> , <code>advent-overlay.liquid</code> , <code>advent-grid-defaults.liquid</code> , <code>advent-motif.liquid</code> , <code>advent-snow.liquid</code>
<code>assets/</code>	<code>advent-calendar.css</code> , <code>advent-calendar.helpers.js</code> , <code>advent-calendar.js</code>
<code>locales/</code>	<code>en.default.json</code> , <code>en.default.schema.json</code>

Locales: your theme almost certainly already has `en.default.json` and `en.default.schema.json` . Do *not* overwrite them — open each, and merge in the single key:

```
{ "sections": { "advent_calendar": { "no_entry": "Select an Advent calendar entry i
```

Both files can carry the same key.

FASTER ALTERNATIVE With Shopify CLI: `shopify theme push --theme <id> --only`

`"sections/advent-calendar.liquid" --only "snippets/advent-*" --only "assets/advent-calendar.*" --only "locales/*"` . Never push the whole folder over a live theme.

2 • Create metaobject definition — `advent_calendar_day`

Settings → **Custom data** → **Metaobjects** → **Add definition**. Name it **Advent Calendar Day**; confirm the type handle is exactly `advent_calendar_day` . Add these fields (the key must match exactly):

Key	Type	Required	Validation
day	Integer	Yes	min 1, max 25
title	Single line text	Yes	—
message	Rich text	Yes	—
code	Single line text	No	—
motif	Single line text	No	Preset choices (10, below)
image	File	No	Images only
link_url	URL	No	—
link_label	Single line text	No	—
grid_area	Single line text	No	— (layout override, step 7)
grid_area_mobile	Single line text	No	—

motif preset choices, exactly these ten, in order: wreath , candle , star , gift , tree , bell , snowflake , stocking , bauble , candycane . Empty / unknown falls back to wreath . There is deliberately no size field — a door's size is the two span values inside grid_area .

3 · Create metaobject definition — advent_calendar

Add definition → name **Advent Calendar**, handle advent_calendar .

Key	Type	Required	Notes / default
heading	Single line text	Yes	—
subheading	Single line text	No	—
background_type	Single line text	No	preset choices <code>solid</code> / <code>gradient</code> / <code>image</code> ; empty = <code>solid</code>
background_color	Color	No	type <code>solid</code> . Default <code>#1c1613</code>
gradient_color_start , gradient_color_end , gradient_angle	Color, Color, Integer	No	type <code>gradient</code> (angle 0–360, default 160)
background_image , background_image_dim	File (image), Integer	No	type <code>image</code> ; dim % is a dark overlay for legibility (0–100, default 40)
text_color	Color	No	<code>#f6ede0</code>
door_color	Color	No	<code>#2a3d35</code>
door_text_color	Color	No	<code>#cfe3d4</code>
accent_color	Color	No	<code>#c9a24b</code>
show_snow	True / false	No	default <code>true</code>
start_date	Date	No	door N opens on <code>start_date</code> + <code>(N-1)</code> days; empty → day N of December this year
days	Metaobject list	Yes	list of Advent Calendar Day entries

For `days` : add field → **Metaobject** → turn on *List of entries* → point the reference at the **Advent Calendar Day** definition.

4 • Turn on storefront access

For **both** definitions: open the definition → **Storefront access** (a.k.a. Access → Storefronts) → enable **Web**. Without this the section renders nothing.

5 • Create the 25 day entries + the parent

1. **Advent Calendar Day** → **Add entry**, once per day. Set `day` to the number, fill `title` , `motif` , `message` (type straight into the rich-text editor — plain paragraphs are fine), and `code` where wanted. Leave `grid_area` / `grid_area_mobile` empty to use the built-in mosaic. Set status **Active**. Content to use: `INTEGRATION.md` §5.1 (ported from the React version) — or your own.
2. **Advent Calendar** → **Add entry**. Fill `heading` (+ any colours / `show_snow` / `start_date`). In `days` , add all 25 day entries **in order 1 → 25**. Status **Active**.

SCRIPT ALTERNATIVE

From `shopify-advent-calendar/` with Node ≥ 18 and a custom app token
(`write_metaobject_definitions`, `write_metaobjects`, `read_metaobjects`): `cp scripts/.env.example scripts/.env`, fill it in, then `npm run create-defs` and `npm run seed` — this does steps 2, 3 and 5 for you (still verify step 4). See `INTEGRATION.md` §6.

6 · Add the section to the theme

1. **Online Store** → **Themes** → **Customize** on your working copy.
2. Pick a template (or a section group that accepts sections) → **Add section** → “**Advent calendar**”.
3. In the section settings, under **Content**, set **Advent calendar** to the parent entry from step 5. If the picker is missing on your theme version, use the “...or entry handle” text field and type the entry's handle (e.g. `advent-calendar-default`).
4. **Save**.

7 · Check it, then publish

- **Preview day** (section setting): set 1–25 to walk the doors through locked → today → past; `0` = real date.
- `?day=13` on the preview URL: client-side override to test outside December.
- Open a door → the overlay animates from it; Esc / clicking the backdrop closes it; opened doors are remembered per browser.
- **Layout tweaks:** to move or resize a door, set its `grid_area` to “<row> / <col> / span <height> / span <width>” (1-based; e.g. `1 / 5 / span 2 / span 1`). Turn on **Show layout guides** in the section settings to see holes / overlaps flagged. Grid size is fixed at 7×8 desktop / 4×14 mobile in the settings; if you change it, re-balance every door. Full table + rules: `INTEGRATION.md` §8.
- Colours: the section's *Style overrides* beat the metaobject colour fields, which beat the built-in defaults. Keep text-on-background and door-text-on-door at WCAG AA.
- Background: set `background_type` on the calendar entry to `solid`, `gradient`, or `image`; only that type's fields apply. For an image, raise `background_image_dim` until text is legible. Full detail: `INTEGRATION.md` §9.1.
- Custom door icons: pick another of the ten `motif` values, or add your own SVG / put an image on the door face — `INTEGRATION.md` §10.
- When it looks right: **Themes** → ... → **Publish** the working copy.

If something's wrong

Symptom	Check
Section shows “Select an Advent calendar entry...”	Step 6.3 — the Advent calendar setting (or handle fallback) is not pointing at the parent entry.
Section renders nothing / blank	Step 4 — storefront access not enabled on one or both definitions. Also confirm the parent entry and its 25 days are Active , not draft.
All doors locked in December	Expected before day 1, or if <code>start_date</code> is a future date. Use Preview day to check.
Wrong icon on a door	<code>motif</code> value must be one of the ten preset choices (step 2), lowercase. To add your own icon: <code>INTEGRATION.md</code> §10.
Doors overlap / gaps in the grid	A custom <code>grid_area</code> broke the tiling. Turn on Show layout guides ; clear the field to fall back to the default.
Theme editor didn't update after editing a metaobject	Metaobjects are a separate Admin screen — go back to Customize and refresh the preview.

Advent Calendar for Shopify · quickstart. Full reference: `shopify-advent-calendar/docs/INTEGRATION.md` .

Regenerate this PDF from `quickstart.html` (see the comment at the top of that file).